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THE BATTLE GOES ON

After a week of unparalleled horrors in the Los Angeles area, guarded optimism about containing some of the largest wildfires gave way Saturday to fears that strong Santa Ana winds could return and push the flames toward the J. Paul Getty Museum and UCLA. Helicopters dropped water near Mandeville Canyon road as the Palisades fire spread toward Encino, while firefighters on the ground dug a containment line. Near a stretch of the Pacific Coast Highway where the fires had passed, the devastation became clear. **A12-13.**



JUSTIN SULLIVAN/GETTY IMAGES



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MELINA MARA/WASHINGTON POST

Inside shelters, a high number of serious incidents

Domestic violence, sex offenses among troubling complaints

By Stephanie Ebbert, Deirdre Fernandes, and Neena Hagen
GLOBE STAFF

Newly released state records show that more than 1,000 serious incidents, including more than a dozen alleged sex offenses, were reported at Massachusetts' emergency family shelters during a 20-month period that saw the program triple in size and expand into hotels and motels across the state.

Governor Maura Healey's administration provided the records in late December, just four days before an undocumented immigrant was arrested with 10 pounds of fentanyl and an assault ri-

fle at a Revere hotel that is part of the shelter program.

The arrest prompted Healey on Monday to order an immediate inspection of all shelter facilities and a "full review" of intake procedures at those facilities. Then, on Thursday, her administration acknowledged that it hadn't been performing criminal background checks on shelter residents, something Healey assured Massachusetts residents had been happening back in March, after an alleged rape at a shelter.

On Friday, Healey told reporters she is ordering background checks for all shelter residents and is tapping former Boston police commissioner Edward Davis to review the system's security protocols.

The recent headline-making arrest in Revere was not the first time guns

SHELTERS, Page A14

A boom in ranks of nonfaculty at colleges

Hires for admin posts outpace teaching corps

By Diti Kohli
GLOBE STAFF

Half a decade ago, leaders at Suffolk University in Boston decided to bulk up on staffing. They expanded the college's career development office and mental health counseling department, and padded the ranks of people devoted to "advancement capacity" — nonfaculty roles that run the gamut from fund-raising to alumni relations.

The investments help Suffolk "deliver on our commitment to students," said Suffolk spokesperson Greg Gatlin, and "provide additional support services and opportunities for learning outside of the traditional classroom environment."

Critics say the moves led to lopsided growth: Enrollment and revenue fell, foreshadowing an era of cost-cutting. From 2018 to 2022, the ranks of full-time professors at Suffolk shrank by 29 people, around 8 percent. But the number of administrators — nonteaching staff ranging from the college president to IT directors to financial aid analysts — grew by nearly a fourth.

It's not just Suffolk. Federal data shows universities have hired professional nonfaculty positions at a pace 10 times as fast as tenured professors, and a Globe analysis of 20 Massachusetts colleges found that, altogether, they've added 2,784 full-time professional staff jobs since 2018, compared with

ADMINISTRATORS, Page A8



Former coach Whitney Goldstein faces a long list of allegations from players.

At URI, discontent over choice of coaches

Players want A.D. to answer for abusive climate

By Bob Hohler
GLOBE STAFF

"Let's get vulnerable," the coach said.

It was late February, and the young women of the University of Rhode Island softball team were midway through a distressing start to the 2024 season: 15 defeats in their first 16 games. They had just lost their first game of the day on a trip to Florida and were soon to play another.

Their coach, Whitney Goldstein, was on her way to becoming the third consecutive URI softball coach hired by athletic director Thorr Bjorn to be accused of various forms of abuse.

Goldstein huddled her players and instructed them to engage in what they described as a "trauma dump," to share the worst moments of their lives, according to a complaint filed with the university that cites a long list of alleged emotional mistreatment and health safety concerns involving as many as 20 former players.

The allegations range from
COACHES, Page C11

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All shined up

Sunday: Clear, pleasant. High 35-40. Low 24-29.

Monday: More of the same. High 38-43. Low 27-32.

Complete report, **A22.**

Boston City Councilor Ed Flynn has reportedly decided against challenging Mayor Michelle Wu, and is instead planning to run for reelection to his council seat. **Metro, B1.**

It's time to think Vermont, now that it's feeling like winter. **Magazine.**

A league source said the Patriots are now negotiating on a contract with Mike Vrabel, their lead candidate to be head coach. **Sports, C1.**

The Globe salutes the best high school athletes of the fall season in the All-Scholastics section. **S1-14.**



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